MAHAAMUD SHAKIB

Case Study · Plumbing · Google Ads

$86.97 to $21.05 per conversion. Same daily budget range.

How a plumbing company's Google Ads cost per tracked conversion fell 76% between August and early October 2026.

Client
Plumbing company (name withheld)

Industry
Plumbing · local service

Channel
Google Ads

Result metric
Tracked conversions



Inside this case study

1. Starting numbers and leak points
2. Emergency vs scheduled strategy
3. The weekly optimization loop
4. Results, with honest caveats

-75.8%
Cost per conversion
Aug 1–31 vs Oct 1–5, 2026

4.4×
Conversions per day
0.77 → 3.4

$21.05
Cost per conversion
Oct 1–5, 2026

INTRODUCTION

Plumbing leads are urgent. Your ad spend shouldn't be careless.

A burst pipe at 9pm and a water heater replacement next week are both "plumbing", but they search differently, convert differently and are worth different amounts. Most plumbing accounts treat them the same, and pay for it in wasted clicks, missed calls and numbers nobody can explain.

This case study looks at one plumbing company's Google Ads account, and how cost per tracked conversion moved once the account was tightened up.

QUICK SELF-CHECK

Does this sound like your plumbing business?

1. You pay for clicks from "how to fix a leaky tap" searches
2. "Plumbing jobs" and career searches use up your budget
3. Parts, supplies and course searches sit in your search terms
4. Price-only shoppers click, then never call
5. Calls come in from outside your service area
6. After-hours calls go to voicemail
7. You see clicks, but can't tell which ones led to calls
8. Emergency-priced clicks get spent on low-value jobs
9. Phone calls and forms aren't tracked as separate conversions
10. You can't say which leads were actually worth having

Ticked 3 or more? Your account is probably paying for traffic that was never going to book. That is the first thing a Google Ads audit finds.

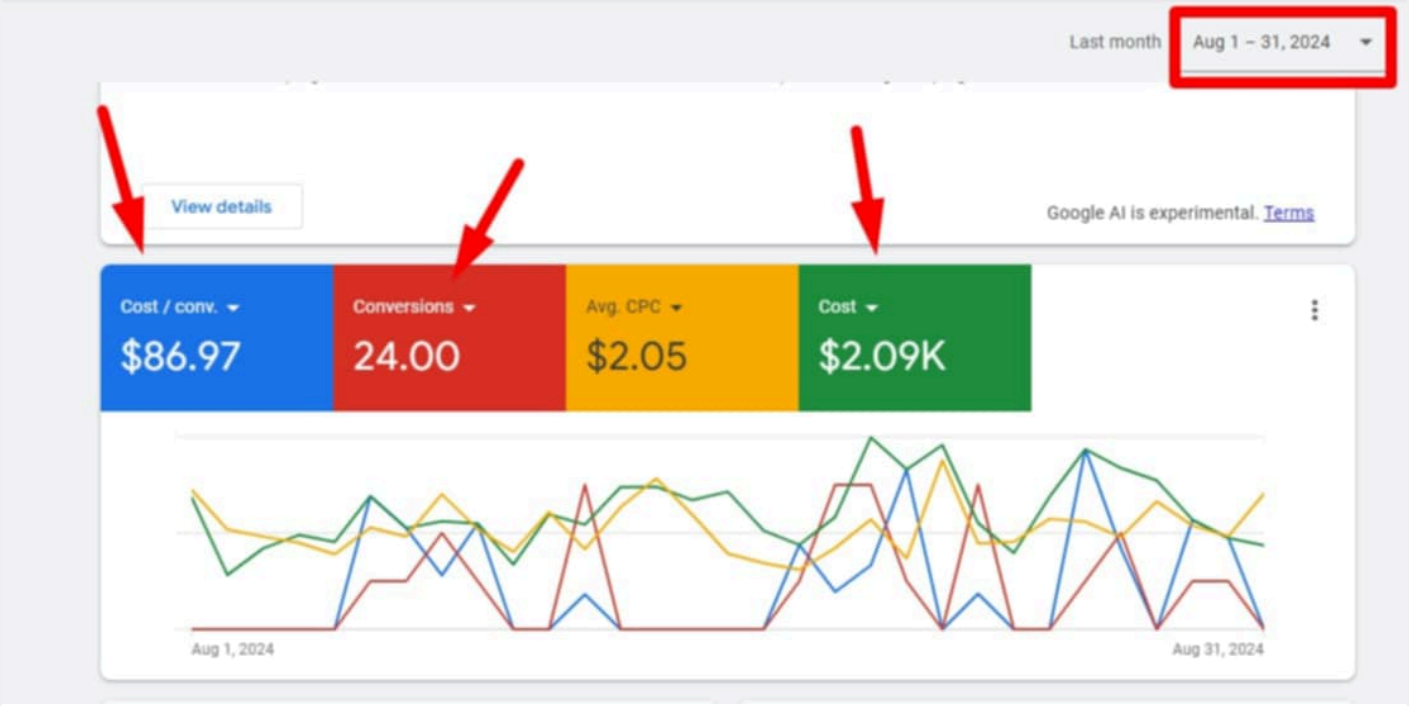
THE STARTING POINT

24 conversions for about $2,090. That's $86.97 each.

The account was spending steadily, around $67 a day, but each tracked conversion was expensive. This is the August 2026 picture before the changes in this case study.

$86.97	24	$2.09K	$2.05
Cost / conv.	Conversions	Cost	Avg. CPC

Google Ads · Aug 1 – 31, 2026



Before: $86.97 cost per conversion, 24 conversions, $2.09K cost (August 1–31, 2026).

Derived: $2,090 ÷ 31 days ≈ $67/day · 24 ÷ 31 days ≈ 0.77 conversions/day.

WHERE I LOOK FIRST

Typical leak points on plumbing accounts

Search terms
DIY, jobs, parts and "free" searches

Match types
Broad terms pulling loose traffic

Location
Calls from outside the service area

Schedule
Spend when nobody answers

Tracking
Calls and forms lumped together

Landing & call path
Clicks that never reach a call

These are the areas I audit by default, not a list of findings from this account.

STRATEGY AND APPROACH

Separate the urgent from the scheduled.

This is my standard framework for a plumbing Google Ads account. The goal is simple: pay for searches that can turn into a call or a form, and stop paying for the rest.

Emergency lines

Searches: burst pipe, leak, blocked drain, no hot water.
Behaviour: urgent, mobile, call-first.
Approach: call-focused ads, tight hours and area, answer fast.

Scheduled lines

Searches: water heater replacement, repiping, drain cleaning, fixture installs.
Behaviour: researched, compared, often a form.
Approach: value-led ads, form and call tracking.

THE FRAMEWORK

1. **Split emergency and scheduled service lines**
   Each gets its own budget, ads and goals, so cheap jobs can't eat emergency spend.
2. **Layer negative keywords**
   Block DIY, jobs, parts, courses and "free" searches at account and campaign level.
3. **Tighten the service area**
   Target the areas you actually serve and review location reports for stray calls.
4. **Call-first mobile ads and ad scheduling**
   Make calling one tap away, and show ads when someone can pick up.
5. **Track calls and forms separately**
   Different lead types need different conversion actions so you can see what works.
6. **Review search terms every week**
   Add negatives, promote winning terms, and keep the account clean.

Layered negatives: the usual suspects

diy · how to · jobs · career · salary · course · training · parts · supplies · free · cheap · tutorial

Starting list only. The real list comes from reading the account's own search terms.

OPTIMIZATION PROCESS

A weekly loop, then a monthly reset.

Weekly

Search-term review · new negatives · call and form check · ad and keyword tweaks

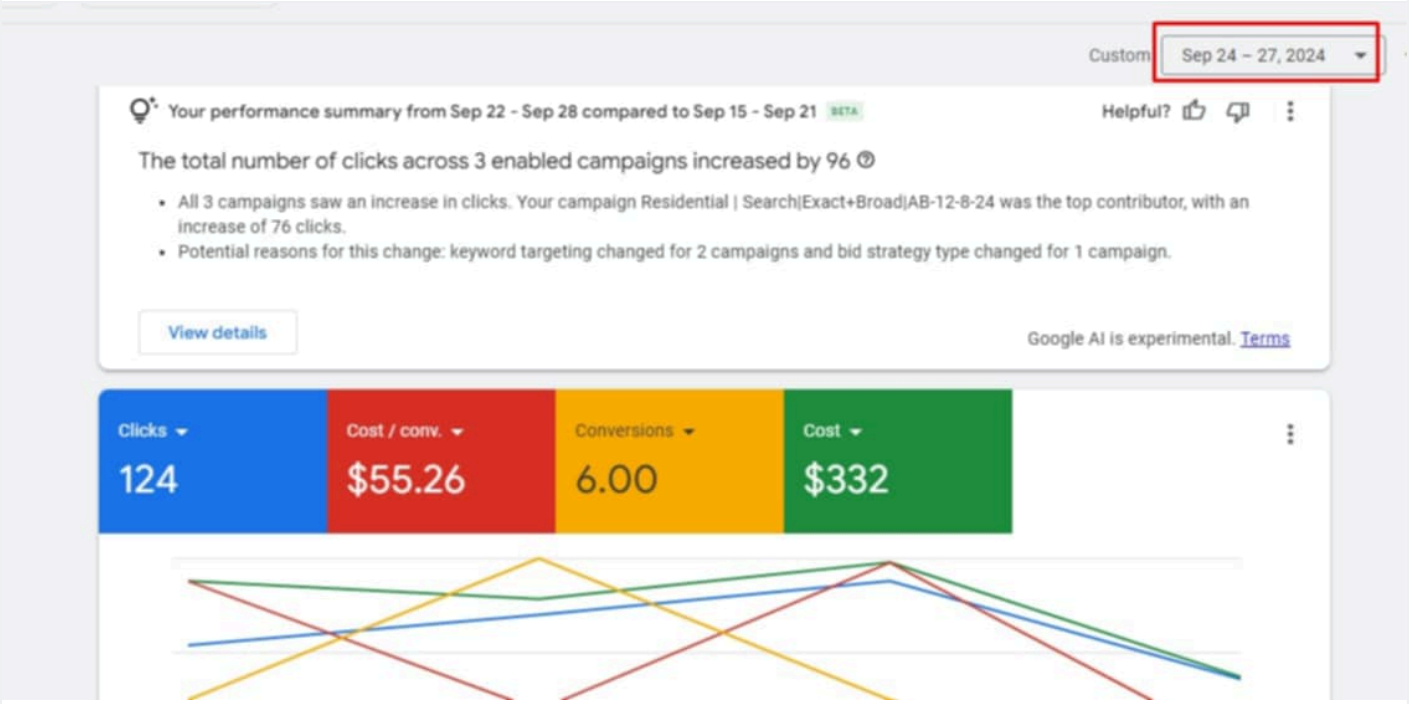
Monthly

Bid strategy · budget split · location and schedule review · conversion tracking check

Cost per conversion across the three windows



Google Ads · Sep 24 – 27, 2026



Mid-period: $55.26 cost per conversion, 6 conversions, $332 cost. Google's summary notes keyword targeting changed for 2 campaigns and bid strategy for 1.

Honest note: this is a 4-day window, and clicks cost more here (about $2.68 each: $332 ÷ 124) than in August ($2.05). They converted better though: 6 conversions from 124 clicks is 4.8%. Reported $55.26 vs $332 ÷ 6 = $55.33 is Google Ads rounding.

RESULTS

Roughly the same daily spend. Four times the conversions.

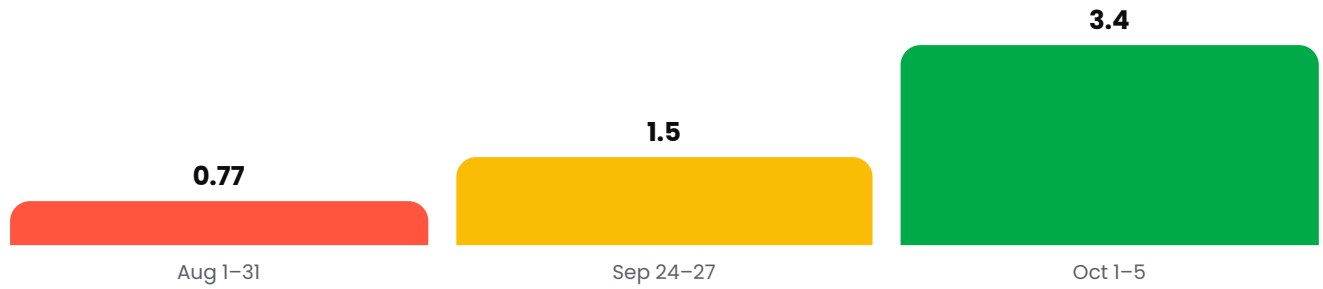
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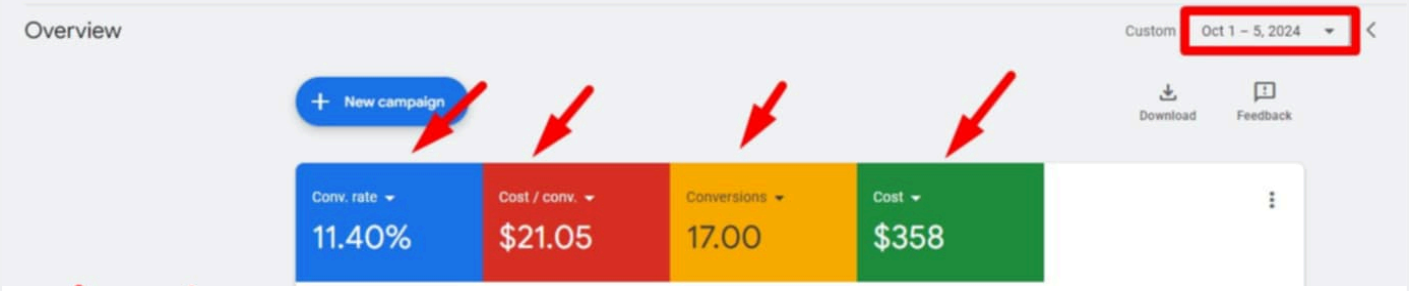
+6%
Daily spend
≈$67 → ≈$72

11.40%
Conv. rate
Oct 1–5, 2026

Conversions per day



Google Ads · Oct 1 – 5, 2026



After: $21.05 cost per conversion, 17 conversions, $358 cost, 11.40% conversion rate (October 1–5, 2026).

What this means for a plumber

Each tracked conversion cost about $65.92 less than in August ($86.97 - $21.05), while daily spend barely moved. For a plumber, that is the difference between paying for clicks and paying for chances to answer a call or quote a job.

Windows are 31, 4 and 5 days long and may overlap with other reporting periods. Figures are as reported in Google Ads. These are tracked conversions, not booked jobs or revenue.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Five things to take from this.

1. Watch cost per conversion, not just clicks. It is the number that tells you whether the spend is working.
2. Cleaner traffic beats more traffic. Daily spend stayed near $67–$83 while conversions per day rose 4.4×.
3. Track calls and forms as separate conversions so you know which lead type is paying off.
4. Review search terms every week. DIY, jobs and parts searches creep back in.
5. Judge results over long enough windows. Short windows swing, and the October figures here cover 5 days.

NO OBLIGATION

Free Google Ads audit

I'll look through your plumbing account and show you where money is leaking. I'll review:

- ✓ Search terms and wasted clicks
- ✓ Service area and ad schedule
- ✓ Emergency vs scheduled structure
- ✓ Negative keyword coverage
- ✓ Call and form tracking
- ✓ Cost per conversion trend

Book Your Free Call →

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